

Fermented pepper mash

Monday, February 12, 2024

4:34 PM

35-40 chinense peppers

1/2 sweet onion

1 large clove of garlic

2 organic carrots

Wash veg in cool water

Chop all in food processor

Weigh all ingredients

Ex: if 430g you want 2% salt which is 8.6g

Formula is (weight of ingredients including water if added) X .02

*I use .025 for my formula

Mix the salt in well

Add to a mason jar of the appropriate size. Ideally, you want to have about 1/2 to 1 inch of headspace between the ingredients in the top of the jar.

You will either have to burp the jar every day if you use a standard lid or you can get an airlock lid that will let gas out, but not back in.

What you can do additionally to improve the ferment process and avoid any problems with spoilage is cut a piece of parchment slightly larger than the lid being used and press that down on top of the ingredients before sealing the jar. In addition to this, you can also use fermentation weights that they make specifically for this that are typically glass and will sit on top of the ingredients and hold them down.

One other half that can be done when fermenting is to use a grape leaf instead of parchment to cover the ingredients. Great leaves have tannins in them. That will help keep things like pickles and whole peppers crunchier.

You should also be sure to clean the top of the jar before placing the lid on to make sure there are no contaminants on the rim of the jar.

- ☐ Measuring the pH of your ferment to tell when it's done
C. Botulinum will not grow in acidic conditions below 4.6 so set a target of about 4.0 as the finishing point.
- ☐ Anytime you firm it you need to put it in the refrigerator. Otherwise it will keep fermenting.
- ☐ If you can or pasteurize after fermenting, you will be killing off the beneficial bacteria
- ☐ Ferment like this can last up to a year in the refrigerator